12.4 Working with Forms

Forms are used to receive information from the user. Forms are commonly used to allow users to register on a Web site, to log in to a Web site, to order a product, and to send feedback. In search engines, forms are used to accept the keywords for search.

The <form> tag is used to create a form. An HTML from starts with <form> and ends with </form> tag. Forms contain many types of form elements, such as text boxes, radio buttons, check boxes, buttons and drop-down lists.

The form has a special element, which is **submit** button, which will submit the entries of a form to a server application to process the entries. Each element in the form is assigned a name using the **name** attribute. Users enter values into the text boxes, or make selections from the radio buttons, check boxes, and drop down lists. The values they enter or select are passed with the name of the corresponding form element to the Web server.

12.4.1 Attributes frequently used with <form> tag

The important attributes used with the <form> tag are method and action attributes.

Method

The method attribute of the **form** tag is used to identify how the form element names and values will be sent to the server. The **get** method will append the names of the form elements and their values to the URL. The **post** method will send the names and values of the form elements as packets.

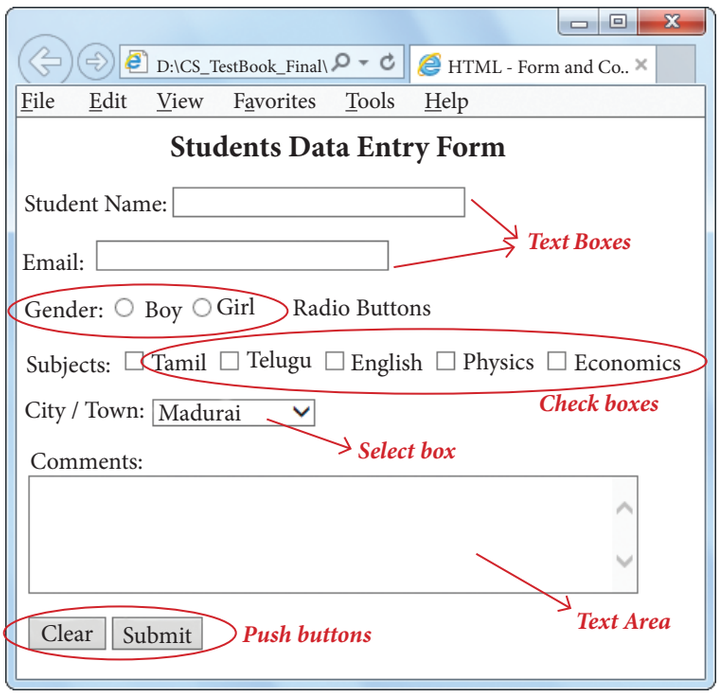


Figure 12.1 HTML Form Controls

Action

The **action** attribute identifies the server side program or script that will process the form. The action will be the name of a Common Gateway Interface (CGI) program written in programming languages like Perl, JavaScript, PHP or Active Server Pages (ASP). (This will be discussed with JavaScript in this book).

General Format of <form> tag

<Form method=get/post action= "back_end_server_script">

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